

HAMILTONIAN ELEMENTS IN ALGEBRAIC K-THEORY

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ABSTRACT. A Hamiltonian fibration $M \hookrightarrow P \rightarrow X$ (with monotone compact fibers) induces a kind of “bundle of A_∞ categories” over X , with fiber given by the Fukaya category of M . Algebraic K -theory ideas, together with the above picture for $X = S^m$, yield the following: if R is a regular ring and G is a compact Lie group then there is a natural group homomorphism $\pi_m(BG) \rightarrow K_m(R) \oplus K_{m-1}(R)$. Given a Hamiltonian fibration as above, the construction generally first assigns elements in a certain categorified algebraic K -theory of R , analogous to Toën’s secondary K -theory. Taking the Langlands dual of G , one may ask for a relationship between the images of the homomorphisms above. This is thematically a K -theory expression of electric-magnetic duality.

1. INTRODUCTION

A guiding idea is that a Hamiltonian M -fibration over a smooth manifold X gives a kind of “bundle of A_∞ categories”, with fiber the Fukaya category of M . Exactly what this means is an interesting mathematical problem in its own right, and one answer is developed in [17]. Note that we are certainly not talking about local systems, as the “bundles” that one gets are generally non-trivial over spheres as shown in [16].

The second idea due to Toën [20], is that there is a refinement of K -theory of a commutative ring R , by replacing R -modules with dg or A_∞ categories over R , and using Waldhausen K -theory. We show that these two ideas naturally fit together. This culminates in a connection between symplectic geometry and algebraic K -theory, and in particular we get a certain geometric insight into what we call categorified algebraic K -theory of $\mathbb{Z}$. We are then naturally led to speculate on connections with Langlands duality phenomena.

Although in the main examples here the principal actors are compact groups and $PU(n)$ in particular, the framework is most naturally understood from the perspective of the group of Hamiltonian symplectomorphisms of some symplectic manifolds; so we quickly introduce this. Let (M, ω) be a symplectic manifold, throughout assumed to be compact, with ω a closed non-degenerate 2-form on M . The group of diffeomorphisms ϕ of M , satisfying $\phi^*\omega = \omega$, is called the symplectomorphism group of (M, ω) . When M is simply connected, this is also the group of Hamiltonian symplectomorphisms, which we denote by $\mathcal{H} = \text{Ham}(M, \omega)$. In general, a symplectomorphism is Hamiltonian if it is the time-one map of an isotopy generated by a family of vector fields $\{X_t\}$, $t \in [0, 1]$, satisfying

$$\omega(X_t, \cdot) = dH_t(\cdot),$$

for some family of smooth functions $\{H_t\}$ on M .

The group $\mathcal{H}$ is one of the more enigmatic objects of mathematics. It is always (unless $M = pt$) an infinite-dimensional Fréchet Lie group with its C^∞ topology. But it has a natural, bi-invariant Finsler metric called the Hofer metric. So in some ways it behaves like a compact group. Its topological and algebraic structure is tied to the main problems of Hamiltonian dynamics, see for instance Polterovich [12].

Much of the algebraic/topological structure of $\mathcal{H}$ is reflected in the properties of Hamiltonian fibrations, which are the main geometric ingredients in what follows. A *Hamiltonian fibration* $M \hookrightarrow P \rightarrow Y$ is

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a smooth fiber bundle over Y , with fiber a symplectic manifold (M, ω) , whose structure group is contained in $\text{Ham}(M, \omega)$. For example, take $(M, \omega) = (\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$ where ω_{FS} is the Fubini-Study symplectic form, and take the structure group $G = PU(n+1) \subset \text{Ham}(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$.

The other ingredient is algebraic K -theory, which is a construction associating an infinite loop space ¹ $K(R)$ to any ring R , and so abelian groups:

$$K_m(R) = \pi_m(K(R)), \quad m \in \mathbb{N},$$

called K -theory groups of R . This is a powerful tool in algebraic topology and ring theory, with applications in number theory and geometric topology.

Taking R to be the non-commutative ring $\mathcal{K}$ of compact operators on a separable complex Hilbert space, the algebraic K -theory space $K(\mathcal{K})$ ² is identified with the topological K -theory space $KU = BU \times \mathbb{Z}$, see Karoubi [6], Suslin-Wodzicki [19]. In particular, a complex vector bundle E over a space X determines a homotopy class $[f_E : X \rightarrow K(\mathcal{K})]$, which we might call a *geometric element* of the corresponding abelian group. We shall see that in a certain sense this extends to a general ring R , provided it is commutative, and replacing a complex vector bundle by a suitable Hamiltonian fibration.

For each commutative ring R we construct “categorified algebraic K -theory groups” $K_m^{Cat}(R)$. Actually it will be convenient to define more general groups $K^{Cat}(X, R)$ for each simplicial set X , generated by aforementioned bundles of A_∞ categories over X with fibers A_∞ categories with finite type, see Definition 3.1. This is analogous to the group of classes $[Y \rightarrow K(\mathcal{K})]$ for Y a space, i.e. the topological K -theory of Y .

In principle, this categorified algebraic K -theory of R is a mostly minor variation of the secondary K -theory of R introduced by Toën, with the main difference that $\mathbb{Z}$ -graded chain complexes are replaced by $\mathbb{Z}_2$ -graded chain complexes. By way of the Hochschild chain functor, $K_m^{Cat}(R)$ should admit a natural map to the 2-periodic variant of algebraic K -theory of R , which we denote by $K_m^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R)$, see Remark 3.7, although we don’t yet need this.

Remark 1.1. It was pointed out to me by Bertrand Toën that for R a regular ring, for example $R = \mathbb{Z}$, $K_m^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R) \simeq K_m(R) \oplus K_{m-1}(R)$. This can be proved with A^1 homotopy theory.

To obtain “geometric elements”, we start with a Hamiltonian fibration $M \hookrightarrow P \rightarrow Y$, with fiber a monotone symplectic manifold. The following is a conjunction of Theorem 4.3 and Corollary 4.6.

Theorem 1.2. *If the Fukaya category of M is finite type, then for each R the data of the isomorphism class of P determines an element in $K^{Cat}(Y_\bullet, R)$. In particular, this gives mappings*

$$\phi_m : \pi_m(B \text{Ham}(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})) \rightarrow K_m^{Cat}(R),$$

and so mappings

$$\phi_m : \pi_m(BPU(n)) \rightarrow K_m^{Cat}(R).$$

Example 1. In the case of $n = 1$, in [16] using geometric arguments we outline the proof of non-triviality of g_4 for $R = \mathbb{Z}$. This stands in contrast to a theorem of Rognes [14] on the triviality of $K_4(\mathbb{Z})$.

Claim 1.3. *$K_2^{Cat}(\mathbb{Z})$ is infinitely generated.*

¹In this paper, the term infinite loop space is meant to be synonymous with connective Ω -spectrum, i.e. a sequence of spaces $\{E_n\}_{n \in \mathbb{N}}$ with $E_n \simeq \Omega E_{n+1}$. Then $K(R)$ is the notation for the 0-space E_0 of the corresponding spectrum.

²Rather one must take a certain non-connective variant of the algebraic K theory construction.

The proof of this is by using the mappings g_2 to construct group injections

$$\mathbb{Z}_p \simeq \pi_2(BPU(p)) \rightarrow K_2^{Cat}(\mathbb{Z})$$

for all prime p . The details will appear elsewhere. Since the groups $K_m(\mathbb{Z})$ (and hence $K_m^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(\mathbb{Z})$ assuming Remark 1.1) are always finitely generated by foundational results of Quillen [13], the latter conclusion is perhaps surprising.

Our construction also gives the following, which in principle also lifts to categorified algebraic K -theory, see Section 4.1.

Theorem 1.4. *For any compact Lie group G , there is a homotopy natural map:*

$$(1.5) \quad h : BG \rightarrow K^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R),$$

and so there are natural homomorphisms

$$h_m : \pi_m(BG) \rightarrow K_m^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R).$$

Taking the Langlands dual of G , we may ask about the correspondence of the respective mappings; we outline this in Section 6.

Question 1. Can one obtain the classes

$$[BG \rightarrow K^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R)]$$

by techniques of homotopy theory and algebraic geometry? In other words, can we bypass the geometric analysis of the construction?

2. PRELIMINARIES

We will partly follow Keller [7], but our base commutative ring will be denoted R to avoid overloading notation. An A_∞ category C over R is a type of non-associative dg-category, with $hom_C(a, b)$ a cochain complex over R . We refer the reader to standard references for further details, see for instance [11] which will come in use later.

Denote by $A_\infty Cat_R^{strict}$ the category of strictly unital, $\mathbb{Z}$ -graded A_∞ categories with morphisms strict A_∞ functors. We set $A_\infty Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_n, strict}$ to be like $A_\infty Cat_R^{strict}$ but with chain complexes $\mathbb{Z}_n$ -graded instead of $\mathbb{Z}$ -graded. This means that all structure maps, functors, etc., are with respect to the $\mathbb{Z}_n$ grading. Various subscripts R may be omitted.

Let $Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_n}$ denote the category of small R -linear $\mathbb{Z}_n$ -graded categories. For $C \in A_\infty Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_n, strict}$, set $hC \in Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_n}$ to be the category with the same objects and with $hom_{hC}(a, b) = H_0(hom_C(a, b))$.

Given a morphism $f : A \rightarrow B$ in $A_\infty Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_n, strict}$, we denote by $f_* : hA \rightarrow hB$ the induced morphism in $Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_n}$. We say that f is a *quasi equivalence* if f_* is an equivalence. We will say that f is a *Morita equivalence* if $T(f) : T(A) \rightarrow T(B)$ is a quasi equivalence, or if equivalently the induced functor $\mathcal{D}(B) \rightarrow \mathcal{D}(A)$ is an equivalence where $\mathcal{D}(A)$ denotes the derived category of A . We denote by $Hmo^{\mathbb{Z}_2}$ the homotopy category of $A_\infty Cat_R^{strict, \mathbb{Z}_2}$ with respect to Morita equivalences, this is a pointed category with the zero object: the category 0 with one object and zero endomorphism complex.

The category $A_\infty Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_n, strict}$ is cocomplete, see [11]. Furthermore, it has a model category structure [10], which by left Bousfield localization yields a Morita model structure with weak equivalences Morita equivalences.

We will specifically need cofiber squares:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} A & \xrightarrow{I} & B \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow P \\ 0 & \longrightarrow & C, \end{array}$$

where I is a cofibration. Explicitly, a cofibration is a strict A_∞ functor, which is injective on objects and on hom sets is a cofibration of the corresponding complexes (in the projective model structure on complexes). Over a field this means that on hom sets the functor is a degree-wise split injection. A cofiber square as above represents the homotopy cofiber.

Definition 2.1. By a *short exact sequence* in $A_\infty \text{Cat}_R^{\text{strict}, \mathbb{Z}_2}$ we mean a sequence $A \xrightarrow{I} B \xrightarrow{P} C$ which fits into a cofiber square as above.

As explained by Keller, an explicit example for such short exact sequences come from Drinfeld dg-quotients.

We now briefly review simplicial sets. We denote by Δ the simplex category:

- The set of objects of Δ is $\mathbb{N}$.
- $\text{hom}_\Delta(n, m)$ is the set of non-decreasing maps $[n] \rightarrow [m]$, where $[n] = \{0, 1, \dots, n\}$, with its natural order.

A simplicial set X is a functor

$$X : \Delta^{op} \rightarrow \text{Set}.$$

$X(n)$ is called the set of n -simplices of X . Δ^d will denote a particular simplicial set: the standard representable d -simplex, with

$$\Delta^d(n) = \text{hom}_\Delta(n, d).$$

Definition 2.2. For X a simplicial set, $\Delta(X)$ will denote the *simplex category of X* . This is the category such that:

- The set of objects $\text{obj } \Delta(X)$ is the set of simplicial maps:

$$\Sigma : \Delta^d \rightarrow X, \quad d \geq 0.$$

- Morphisms $f : \Sigma_1 \rightarrow \Sigma_2$ are commutative diagrams in $s\text{-Set}$:

$$(2.3) \quad \begin{array}{ccc} \Delta^d & \xrightarrow{\quad} & \Delta^n \\ & \searrow \Sigma_1 & \downarrow \Sigma_2 \\ & & X. \end{array}$$

Given a morphism $f : X \rightarrow Y$ of simplicial sets, we set $\Delta f : \Delta(X) \rightarrow \Delta(Y)$ to be the functor defined on objects by $\Delta f(\Sigma) = f \circ \Sigma$. If $m : \Sigma_1 \rightarrow \Sigma_2$ is a morphism in $\Delta(X)$:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Delta^k & \xrightarrow{m} & \Delta^d \\ & \searrow \Sigma_1 & \downarrow \Sigma_2 \\ & & X, \end{array}$$

then obviously the diagram below also commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \Delta^k & \xrightarrow{m} & \Delta^d \\ & \searrow h_1 & \downarrow h_2 \\ & & Y, \end{array}$$

where $h_i = \Delta f(\Sigma_i) = f \circ \Sigma_i$, $i = 1, 2$. And so the latter diagram determines a morphism $\Delta f(m) : h_1 \rightarrow h_2$ in $\Delta(Y)$. Clearly, this determines a functor Δf as needed.

Definition 2.4. Let X be a Kan complex and C any category. Let $F_i : \Delta(X) \rightarrow C$, $i = 0, 1$ be functors. A **concordance** of F_0 to F_1 is a functor $\tilde{F} : \Delta(X \times I) \rightarrow C$ s.t. $\tilde{F}|_{\Delta(X \times \{0\})} = F_0$ and $\tilde{F}|_{\Delta(X \times \{1\})} = F_1$.

3. DEFINITION OF CATEGORIFIED ALGEBRAIC K-THEORY GROUPS OF R

We need to put some algebraic finiteness conditions on our A_∞ categories, otherwise any K -theory we construct will be trivial due to the Eilenberg swindle, the same reason that K -theory of infinite dimensional vector bundles is trivial. A natural requirement is that our A_∞ categories be smooth and proper or saturated in the sense of Kontsevich-Soibelman [9], as this is a dualizability condition, see [21]. In the $\mathbb{Z}_n$ -graded setting the analogue of this condition is more complex, we will instead work with a less restrictive notion, which is not too hard to check for geometric examples.

Set $\mathcal{A} = \mathcal{A}_R \subset A_\infty \text{Cat}_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2, \text{strict}}$ to be the full-subcategory whose objects are finite type, where the latter is defined as follows. And set $w\mathcal{A}_R \subset \mathcal{A}_R$ to be subcategory with the same objects and morphisms Morita equivalences.

Definition 3.1. We say that $B \in A_\infty \text{Cat}_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2, \text{strict}}$ is **finite type** if the following conditions are satisfied.

- B is Morita equivalent to an A_∞ algebra, whose underlying chain complex in each degree is projective and finitely generated over R .
- The Hochschild homology complex of B is quasi-isomorphic to a complex (still 2-periodic) that is in each degree projective and finitely generated.

Definition 3.2. Let X be a simplicial set. An A_∞ **bundle over** X is defined to be a functor $\Delta(X) \rightarrow w\mathcal{A}_R$.

Suppose we have A_∞ bundles over X , fitting into a sequence of natural transformations of functors to $\mathcal{A}_R$:

$$(3.3) \quad F_0 \rightarrow F_1 \rightarrow F_2,$$

s.t. for each object $\Sigma \in \Delta(S^k)$ the resulting sequence in $\mathcal{A}_R$ is a short exact sequence. Then we call $F_0 \rightarrow F_1 \rightarrow F_2$ a **short exact sequence**.

Definition 3.4. We define $K^{\text{Cat}}(X, R)$ to be the quotient of the free abelian group generated by the set of concordance classes $[F]$ of functors $F : \Delta(X) \rightarrow w\mathcal{A}_R$, by the subgroup generated by

$$\{[F_0] - [F_1] + [F_2] \mid \text{there is a short exact sequence } F_0 \rightarrow F_1 \rightarrow F_2\}.$$

This is clearly contravariantly functorial in X so if $f : X \rightarrow Y$ is a simplicial map then we get a group homomorphism $f^* : K^{\text{Cat}}(Y, R) \rightarrow K^{\text{Cat}}(X, R)$ defined on generators by $f^*([F]) = [F \circ \Delta f]$.

Remark 3.5. As classical algebraic K theory groups, this is covariantly functorial in R by “extension of scalars”.

Furthermore, it is a homotopy cofunctor in X , as by definition of concordance it is clear that if f is homotopic to g then $f^* = g^*$. In particular if X_0 is homotopy equivalent to X_1 then $K^{\text{Cat}}(X_0, R) = K^{\text{Cat}}(X_1, R)$.

Set $S_{\text{simp}}^k = \Delta^k / \partial \Delta^k$ for $\Delta^k / \partial \Delta^k$ the natural quotient Kan complex.

Definition 3.6. For $k > 0$, we define

$$K_k^{Cat}(R) = \ker\{(\Delta^0 \rightarrow S_{simp}^k)^* : K^{Cat}(S_{simp}^k, R) \rightarrow K^{Cat}(*, R)\},$$

and define

$$K_0^{Cat}(R) = K^{Cat}(\Delta^0, R).$$

Remark 3.7. The above definition of the groups $K_k^{Cat}(R)$ is meant to be the very direct, and amenable to computation. But from a theory perspective it would be great to explain why these groups are in fact the Waldhausen K -theory groups, that is homotopy groups of a spectrum associated to a certain Waldhausen category underlying $\mathcal{A}_R$. The needed category is already outlined in Toën in [20]. We take the full subcategory $\hat{\mathcal{A}}_R \subset \mathcal{A}_R$ with objects Morita fibrant (pretriangulated and idempotent complete). To be strict this will not be an Waldhausen category but ∞ -Waldhausen in the sense of Barwick [1], as for example the zero category 0 (the category with one object and zero complex as endomorphism set) is not initial in $\hat{\mathcal{A}}_R$ but the hom-sets $\text{hom}_{\hat{\mathcal{A}}_R}(0, A)$ are contractible when taken in the ∞ -localization of $\hat{\mathcal{A}}_R$ with respect to the Morita equivalences. The groups $K_k^{Cat}(R)$ are then exactly the groups $\pi_k(K(\hat{\mathcal{A}}_R))$ with $K(\hat{\mathcal{A}}_R)$ the Waldhausen K -theory spectrum. We postpone the details of this discussion to a future note.

3.1. A very basic computation. We recall the definition of $K_0(R)$. This is the quotient of the free abelian group generated by the set of isomorphism classes of projective finitely generated R -modules, by the subgroup generated by

$$\{[A] - [B] + [C] \mid \text{exists an exact sequence } 0 \rightarrow A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow 0.\}$$

If $\mathcal{E}$ is a triangulated category, one defines $K_0(\mathcal{E})$ to be the quotient of the free abelian group, generated by the set of isomorphism classes in $\mathcal{E}$, by the subgroup generated by

$$\{[A] - [B] + [C] \mid \text{exists a distinguished triangle } A \rightarrow B \rightarrow C \rightarrow A[1].\}$$

It is known that $K_k(D^{perf}(Mod_R)) \simeq K_k(R)$, where Mod_R denotes the category of projective finitely generated R -modules and $D^{perf}(Mod_R)$ denotes the derived category of perfect complexes.

If $D_n(Mod_R)$ denotes the n -periodic derived category, we no longer have that $K_0(R) \simeq K_0(D_n(Mod_R))$, as there are certain corrections, see Saito [15]. We do have:

Theorem 3.8 (Saito [15]). *For n even, the natural homomorphism:*

$$(3.9) \quad \psi : K_0(D_n(Mod_R)) \rightarrow K_0(R)$$

$$(3.10) \quad \psi([V]) = \sum_{i=0}^{i=n} (-1)^i [H_i(V)],$$

is an isomorphism.

There is a group homomorphism $K_0^{Cat}(\mathbb{Z}) \xrightarrow{\phi} K_0(D_2(Mod_{\mathbb{Z}}))$ induced by $[C] \mapsto [Hoch_{\bullet}(C)]$ for $Hoch_{\bullet}(C)$ the Hochschild homology complex of C . This readily follows by the fact that the Hochschild functor $Hoch_{\bullet}$ is “localizing” which means in this case that ϕ takes short exact sequence $C_0 \rightarrow C_1 \rightarrow C_2$ in $\mathcal{A}_R$ is taken to an exact triangle $Hoch_{\bullet}(C_0) \rightarrow Hoch_{\bullet}(C_1) \rightarrow Hoch_{\bullet}(C_2) \rightarrow Hoch_{\bullet}(C_0)[1]$, see Keller [7, Theorem 5.2].

Corollary 3.11. *The composition map*

$$K_0^{Cat}(\mathbb{Z}) \xrightarrow{\phi} K_0(D_2(Mod_{\mathbb{Z}})) \xrightarrow{\psi} K_0(\mathbb{Z}),$$

is non-trivial.

Proof. Take C to be a finite type $\mathbb{Z}_2$ -graded A_∞ algebra over $\mathbb{Z}$ such that $HH_0(C) = \mathbb{Z}$, $HH_1(C) = 0$, $HH_2(C) = \mathbb{Z}$, where $HH_\bullet(C)$ is the homology of $Hoch_\bullet(C)$. As a geometric example take $C = FH_\bullet(L_0, L_0)$ where the latter is the Floer chain algebra of the equator L_0 in S^2 , then the Hochschild homology $HH_\bullet(C)$ is isomorphic to the singular homology $H_\bullet(S^2, \mathbb{Z})$, [18].

So we get

$$\psi([Hoch_\bullet(C)]) = 2[\mathbb{Z}] \neq 0 \in K_0(\mathbb{Z}) \simeq \mathbb{Z}.$$

□

A further corollary of the proof above is:

Corollary 3.12. $[Fuk(S^2, \omega)]$ represents a non-trivial element in $K_0^{Cat}(\mathbb{Z})$.

One natural question is how to produce interesting elements in $K_m^{Cat}(R)$ for higher m . We will construct such elements using Hamiltonian fibrations and Floer theory.

4. A_∞ BUNDLES FROM HAMILTONIAN FIBRATIONS

The main construction of [17] has as input a smooth Hamiltonian fibration $M \hookrightarrow P \rightarrow Y$, with (M, ω) a compact monotone symplectic manifold, e.g. $(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$. Denote by $Y_\bullet$ the simplicial set of smooth singular simplices $\Delta^n \rightarrow Y$ for Δ^n also denoting the standard topological n -simplex.

And the output is a functor

$$(4.1) \quad F_P : \Delta(Y_\bullet) \rightarrow wA_\infty Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2, strict},^3$$

whose concordance class F_P is independent of auxiliary choices.

Definition 4.2. We call a compact monotone symplectic manifold, whose monotone Fukaya category (see [18]) is finite type, **finite monotone type**.

To summarize, we obtain the following corollary of [17, Theorem 6.6].

Theorem 4.3. Let $M \hookrightarrow P \rightarrow Y$ be a Hamiltonian fibration with fiber (M, ω) finite monotone type. Then the assignment:

$$(4.4) \quad [P] \mapsto [F_P] \in K^{Cat}(Y_\bullet, R)$$

is well defined, where $[P]$ is the Hamiltonian isomorphism class of the fibration P .

As an example, we have:

Proposition 4.5. $(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$ is finite monotone type.

Proof. Specifically, we take a concrete model of $Fuk(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$ with the set objects given by the orbit of the Clifford torus L_0 by the natural $\text{Ham}(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega)$ action. In this case it is automatic that $Fuk(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$ is quasi-isomorphic to the A_∞ algebra $\text{hom}_{Fuk(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega)}(L_0, L_0)$. The Hochschild chain complex of the latter is quasi-isomorphic to the Hamiltonian Floer chain complex, see for instance [18], which is in each degree finitely and freely generated over $\mathbb{Z}$. And so $Fuk(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$ is finite type for any R . □

In particular, taking $Y = S^m$ and composing with the natural map

$$K^{Cat}(S_\bullet^m, R) \simeq K^{Cat}(S_{simp}^m, R) \rightarrow K_m^{Cat}(R)$$

we get:

³In [17] we work with $R = \mathbb{Q}$ but this was only used for inverting quasi equivalences. As we don't need to do this here, the construction works over any commutative ring.

Corollary 4.6. *For each commutative ring R , there are natural maps:*

$$(4.7) \quad \phi_m : \pi_m(B \operatorname{Ham}(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})) \rightarrow K_m^{Cat}(R).$$

And so natural maps:

$$(4.8) \quad \phi_m : \pi_m(BPU(n)) \rightarrow K_m^{Cat}(R).$$

Proof. Let $\mathbb{CP}^n \hookrightarrow P \rightarrow B \operatorname{Ham}(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$ be the tautological Hamiltonian fibration, that is the fiber bundle associated to the universal principal $\operatorname{Ham}(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$ bundle over $B \operatorname{Ham}(\mathbb{CP}^n, \omega_{FS})$. Use the conjunction of Proposition 4.5 and Theorem 4.3 to get the needed conclusion. $\square$

The map cl is a group homomorphism, but to show this we need to relate our definition of $K_k^{Cat}(R)$ to the Waldhausen construction, see Remark 3.7, and this will not be carried out here.

4.1. Generalizing to G/T . Given a compact Lie group G , the maximal coadjoint orbit G/T is always monotone with respect to the Kirillov-Kostant-Souriau symplectic structure ω_{KKS} , which for G/T can be uniquely determined up to deformation equivalence, see for instance [8]. We will from now on omit ω_{KKS} from notation. If $G = PU(n)$ there is a distinguished monotone Lagrangian torus L_{GC} of $PU(n)/T$, arising as the central fiber of a Gelfand-Celtin system, see [3, Theorem B]. This is a kind of analogue of the Clifford torus.

It is natural to expect that $Fuk(G/T)$ is finite type. In this case we similarly get homomorphisms $\pi_m(B \operatorname{Ham}(G/T)) \rightarrow K_m^{Cat}(R)$. Note that when we talk about $Fuk(G/T)$ ideally, we are talking about a model ⁴ with finitely many objects up to the $\operatorname{Ham}(G/T)$ action, similarly to how we treated $Fuk(\mathbb{CP}^n)$.

For example, form the sub-category $C_{L_{GC}}$ of $Fuk(PU(n)/T)$ with objects formed by G -orbit of L_{GC} . In this case the finite type condition is forced and we get natural homomorphisms

$$\phi_{L_{GC}, m} : \pi_m(BPU(n)) \rightarrow K_m^{Cat}(R),$$

by the same construction; that is getting bundles of A_∞ categories over S^m with fiber $C_{L_{GC}}$. The images of $\phi_{L_{GC}, m}$ are in principle different from the images of g_m , even restricting to $BPU(n)$. This is just because we are taking different coadjoint orbits, and so are working with different fibrations over $BPU(n)$.

We can also do this for G/T (and more general coadjoint orbits) by constructing a distinguished Lagrangian $\mathcal{L}$, as the central fiber of a toric degeneration of G/T . One of the most well know setups for this is via so called string polytopes and Newton–Okounkov bodies see [4]. For a general G it is widely expected that it $\mathcal{L}$ is monotone, (this in principle depends on the chosen degeneration, it is enough for us that one such degeneration such that $\mathcal{L}$ is monotone exists). Assuming this conjecture for the moment we get a finite type sub-category category $C_{\mathcal{L}} \subset Fuk(G/T, \omega)$, with the set of objects as above the orbit of $\mathcal{L}$ by the $\operatorname{Ham}(G/T, \omega)$ action. This $C_{\mathcal{L}}$ is our “model”.

5. HAMILTONIAN ELEMENTS IN ALGEBRAIC K -THEORY

One of our goals is to obtain “Hamiltonian elements” of classical algebraic K -theory. Let $M \hookrightarrow P \rightarrow Y$ be a Hamiltonian fibration, with compact monotone fiber (M, ω) . Let

$$F_P : \Delta(X_\bullet) \rightarrow wA_\infty Cat_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2, strict}$$

be as in the previous section. Then the composition: $\Phi_P = Hoch_\bullet \circ F_P$ gives a functor to $wCh_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2}$, where $Ch_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2}$ is the Waldhausen category $Ch_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2}$ of 2-periodic complexes of projective finite rank R -modules. It’s Waldhausen K -theory infinite loop space will be denoted by $K^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R)$.

⁴Not necessarily Morita equivalent to $Fuk(G/T)$.

For concreteness specialize to $Y = B\text{Ham}(G/T)$, and P the associated G/T bundle over $B\text{Ham}(G/T)$.
⁵ Note that by standard homotopy theory $|\Delta(Y_\bullet)| \simeq X$ where for a category C , $|C|$ is shorthand for the geometric realization of the nerve. Then we get a map:

$$|\Phi_P| : B\text{Ham}(G/T) \rightarrow |wCh_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2}|,$$

whose homotopy class is well defined by the fact that the concordance class of F_P is well defined.

Composing with the natural map $|wCh_R^{\mathbb{Z}_2}| \rightarrow K^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R)$, coming from the construction of $K^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R)$, see [22, Remark 8.3.2], we get a natural homotopy class:

$$(5.1) \quad [|\Phi_P| : B\text{Ham}(G/T) \rightarrow K^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R)].$$

Proof of Theorem 1.4. Use the natural map

$$BG \rightarrow B\text{Ham}(G/T),$$

and (5.1). □

6. LANGLANDS DUAL ALGEBRAIC K-THEORY ELEMENTS.

It is natural to ask how Langlands duality fits into our story. Denote by $K^\vee$ the maximal compact subgroup of the Langlands dual of the complexification $G_{\mathbb{C}}$. Via Theorem 1.4, we have natural maps:

$$\begin{aligned} h_{G,m} : \pi_m(BG) &\rightarrow K_m^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R), \\ h_{K^\vee,m} : \pi_m(BK^\vee) &\rightarrow K_m^{\mathbb{Z}_2}(R). \end{aligned}$$

If G is simply laced (e.g. $G = SU(n)$) it is not hard to see that the images of these maps are the same, as $G/T = K^\vee/T$ and the images of G and $K^\vee$ in $\text{Ham}(G/T)$ coincide. A tentative conjecture would be:

Conjecture 1. *For each compact Lie group G the images of ϕ_G and $\phi_{K^\vee}$ coincide.*

Furthermore, there should be a “lifts”, see Section 4.1:

$$\begin{aligned} \phi_{\mathcal{L},G} : \pi_m(BG) &\rightarrow K_m^{\text{Cat}}(R), \\ \phi_{\mathcal{L},K^\vee} : \pi_m(BK^\vee) &\rightarrow K_m^{\text{Cat}}(R), \end{aligned}$$

and we can again ask if the images coincide. For $m = 0$ this is saying that $Fuk(G/T)$ and $Fuk(K^\vee/T)$ ⁶ represent the same classes in $K_0^{\text{Cat}}(R)$. This assertion would hold if these categories were Morita equivalent, but it is much weaker. The case $m = 0$ is then comparable to the homological mirror symmetry conjecture of Kontsevich.

If we take the general point of view of Kapustin-Witten [5], then the above conjecture is thematically a rudimentary K -theory expression of the electric-magnetic duality. One possibly related foundational work on topological aspects of Langlands duality is [2].

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⁵To be even more concrete, in the construction of F_P we can work with models of the type $C_{\mathcal{L}}$, Section 4.1, so that $F_P(\Sigma)$ for each Σ is a category with finitely many objects all of which are isomorphic to a distinguished object, corresponding to $\mathcal{L}$ in Section 4.1.

⁶Or to be more restrictive, their models $C_{\mathcal{L}}$ as in Section 4.1.

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